Dungeon Fantasy Adventure

#2D scroll
#pixel

Game Overview

A 2D side-scrolling dungeon RPG. Explore procedurally generated dungeons, fight skeletons, collect powerful loot and level up. Venture deeper to reveal dark secrets and face the formidable Leviathan.

Video link:
https://youtu.be/oG49EA0EPN8

Game link:
https://wangwu-1.itch.io/dungeon-fantasy-adventure

Github link:
https://github.com/Wangwu-1/-2d-dungeon-rpg

Inspiration

This project draws inspiration from medieval European travel culture and the imaginative depictions of unknown worlds in fantasy literature. In an era when transportation and communication were limited, distant lands were often associated with legends, danger, and mystery, making exploration itself an exciting adventure.

The game follows a modern teenage girl who unexpectedly finds herself in a medieval world. Through pixel art, it creates an adventurous setting that blends historical atmosphere with fantasy elements. Players will explore unfamiliar environments, engage in combat, and gradually uncover the world's secrets, experiencing the journey from initial curiosity and fascination to stepping into the unknown.







Reference



For visual presentation, I adopt pixel art as my core aesthetic to evoke the grainy texture of memory and imagination. Heavily inspired by the Ori series, which uses dynamic lighting, layered colour gradients and fluid animations to achieve striking 2-D visuals, I translate its painterly colour treatment and cinematic composition into a pixel-art style, even though Ori itself is not pixel-based.



For the game's pacing, I drew inspiration from Celeste. Its precise platforming mechanics, quick retries, and tightly designed levels make failure a natural part of exploration. I aim to incorporate this smooth and responsive gameplay experience into my project, allowing players to learn and progress through challenges.

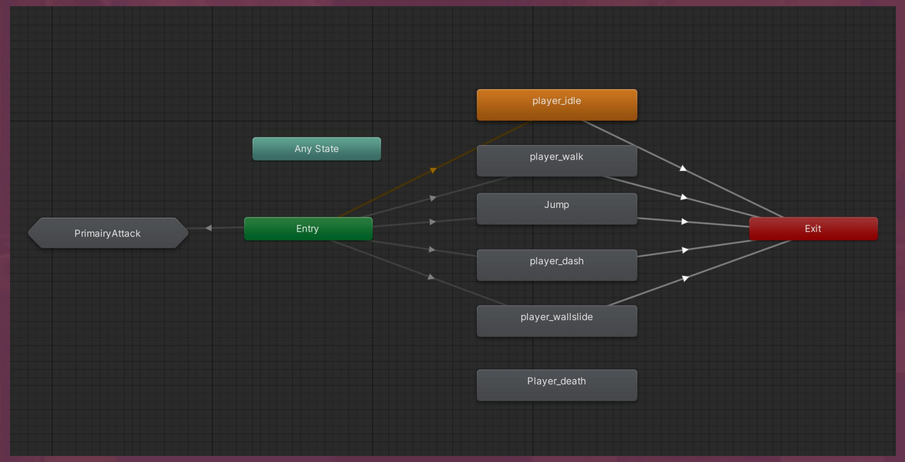


For the overall gameplay structure, I referenced Hollow Knight: Silksong. Its combination of interconnected areas, ability progression, combat, and quests encourages players to continuously discover new paths and objectives.

Character Design



Name：Apple
Gender: female
Age:18
Story:A girl who longs for a life of fantasy and adventure finds herself transported to the Middle Ages once again by a twist of fate. There, she embarks on a journey to uncover the mysteries of the world.



For character animation control, I used a state machine to manage different animation states, updating it with each animation frame to ensure smooth and timely transitions. This approach prevents animation desynchronisation and stuttering caused by overlapping states, maintaining fluid and consistent character movements.

Movement System

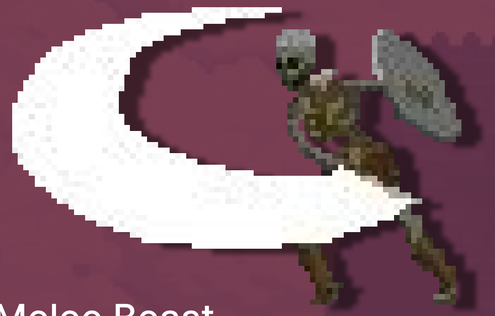


Battle System



This animation demonstrates the character's attack combo. Inspired by classic action game combat systems, I designed a Light–Light–Heavy attack sequence to create a smooth, intuitive, and accessible combat experience, allowing players to engage with the game naturally and enjoy a satisfying sense of rhythm.

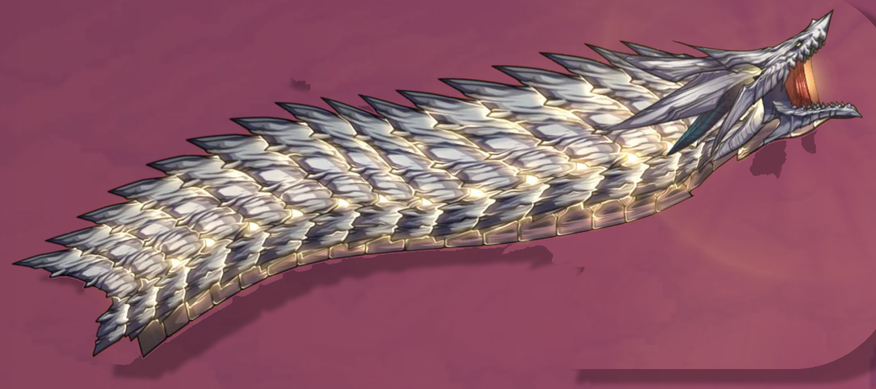
Enemy Design



Melee Beast
- Type: Melee Enemy
- Attack: Close-range pursuit attacks
- Behaviour: Constantly pressures the player
- Role: Creates combat threats



Ranged Mage
- Type: Ranged Enemy
- Attack: Long-range magical attacks
- Behaviour: Restricts player movement
- Role: Disrupts combat rhythm



Leviathan - final boss
- Type: Giant Deep-Sea Boss
- Attacks: Sweeping strikes, fire breath, and a four-directional energy attack
- Mechanics: Wide-area attacks create pressure, requiring players to observe attack patterns, dodge, and deal continuous damage to break its armour
- Defeat: Leviathan collapses, unlocking a brief escape window

Level Design

Environmental Interactions

Level Transition



- Mechanic: Fade-to-black transition
- Function: Connects different levels

Obstacle



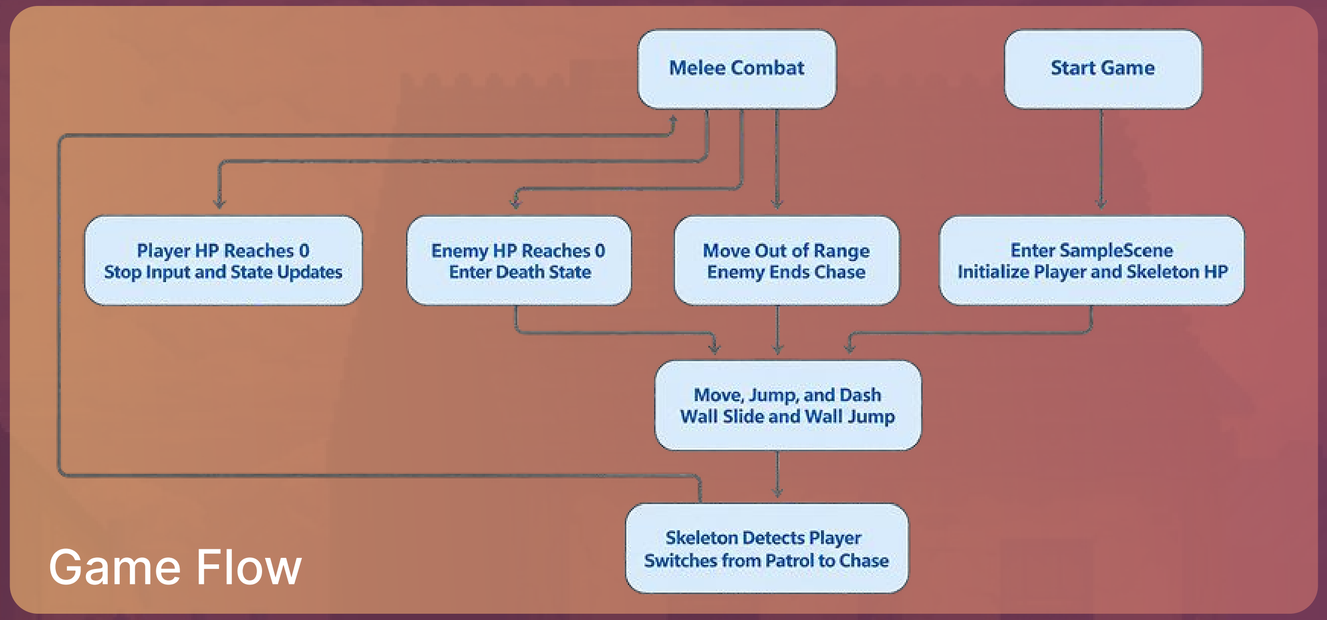
- Mechanic: Attack to destroy doors
- Function: Unlocks new paths

Spike Trap

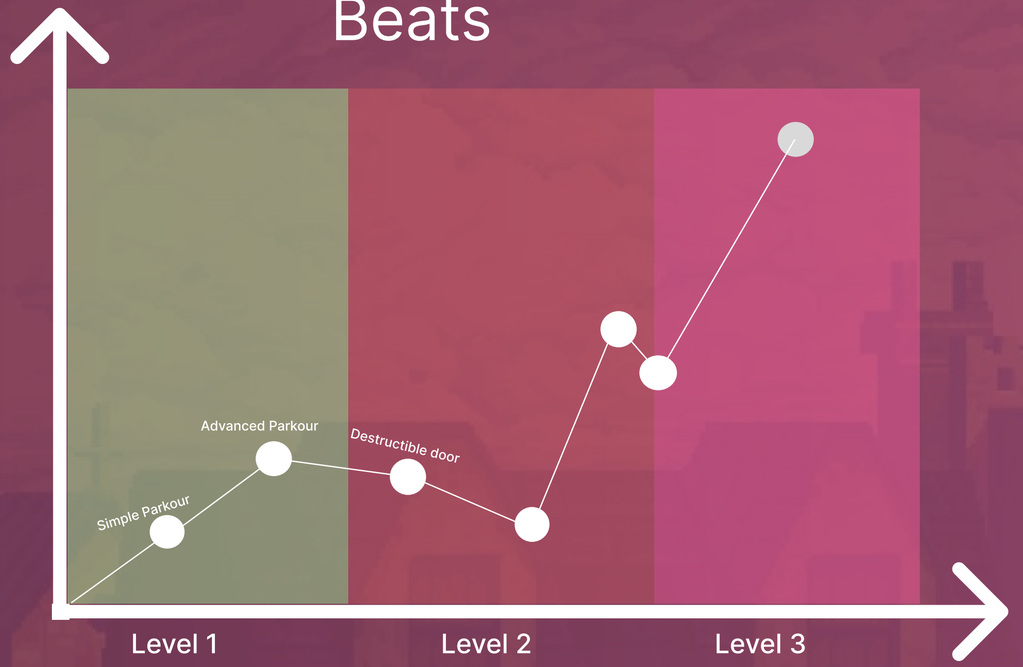


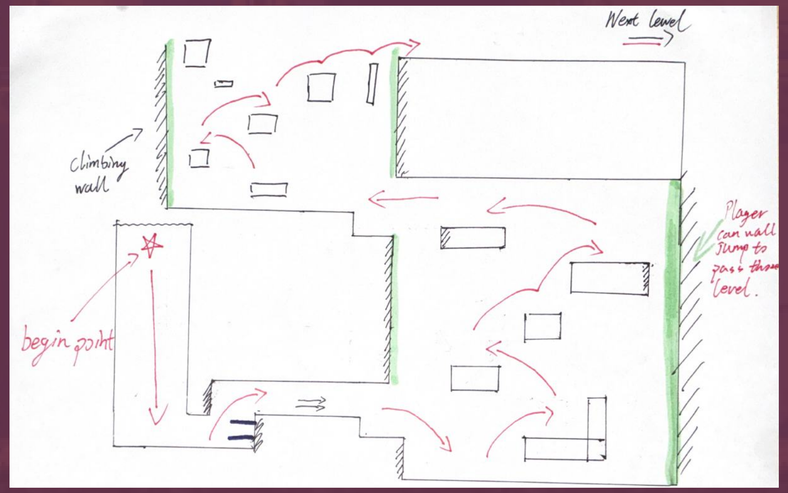
- Mechanic: Deals damage on contact
- Effect: Returns the player to their previous positi

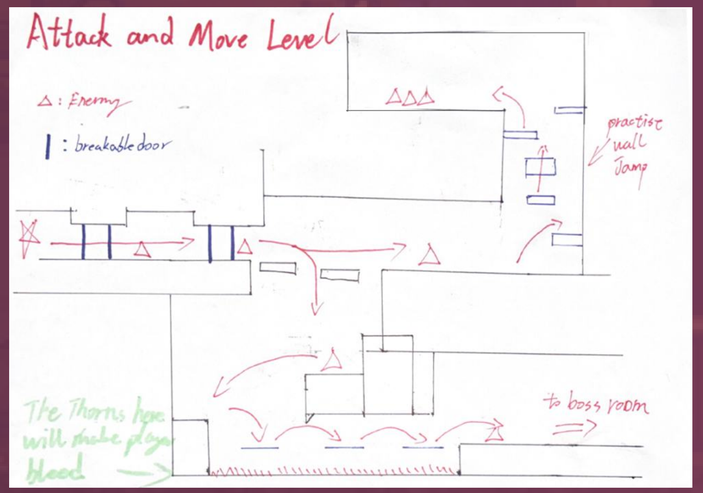
Level Design

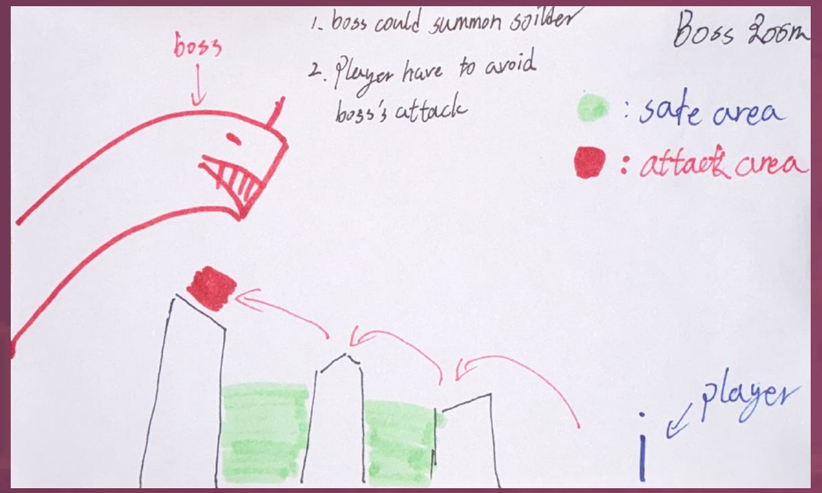


Game Flow





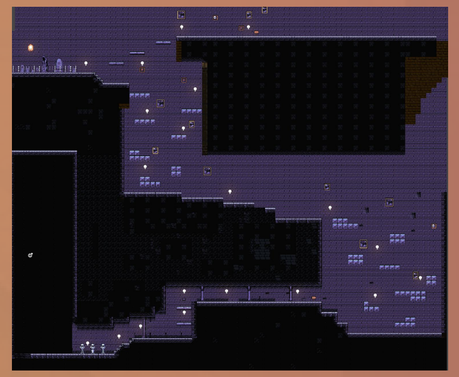




Map Draft

Level Design

Level 1 — Movement Fundamentals ★★★

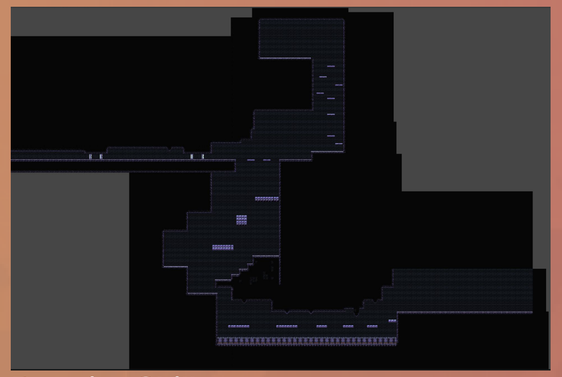


Design Goal
Introduce the core movement mechanics and help players build confidence in navigating the environment.

Gameplay
Two platforming challenges introduce basic movement, wall climbing, and jumping. Players practise judging distances and timing their jumps, building a foundation for the more demanding traversal and combat encounters ahead.

Require Skills
Basic Movement

Level 2 — Combat & Exploration ★★★

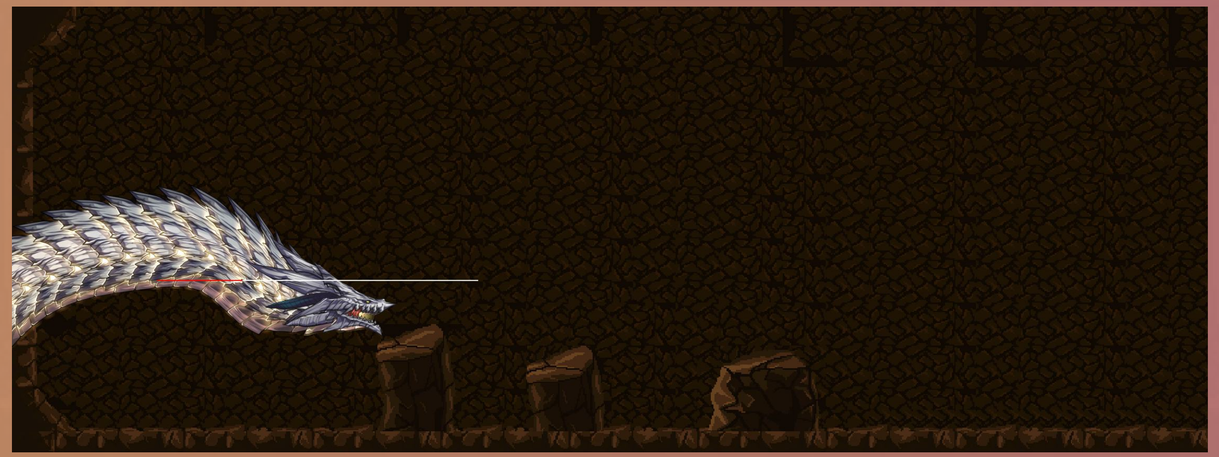


Design Goal
Develop combat skills while encouraging players to explore and combine movement abilities.

Gameplay
Destructible doors and enemy encounters give players opportunities to practise attacking and dashing. The upper route rewards exploration with the wall-jump ability, while the lower route challenges players to combine dashes and jumps to progress. Together, these routes connect ability discovery with practical movement challenges.

Require Skills
Attacking · Dashing · Jumping
Ability Unlock: Wall Jump

Level3--Boss ★★★



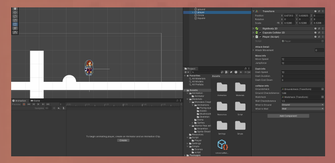
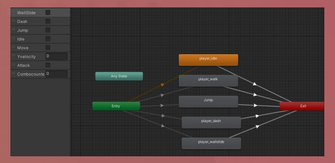
Design Goal
Introduce the core movement mechanics and help players build confidence in navigating the environment.

Gameplay
Players must jump between platforms to reach positions from which they can attack the boss, while using jumps and dashes to evade its attacks. The encounter tests timing, positioning, and the ability to switch between offence and defence, turning individual mechanics into a coordinated combat challenge.

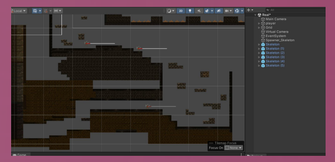
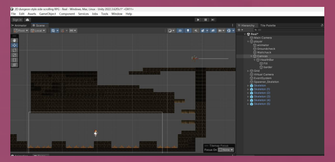
Require Skills
Platforming · Attack Timing · Dash Evasion

Test

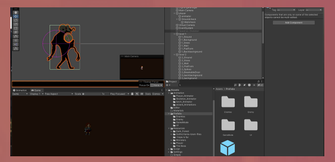
Version1
Character Behaviour Tree Build

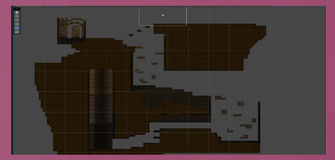
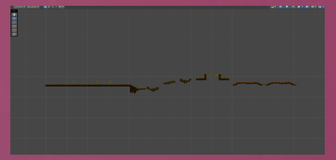
Version2
enemy build

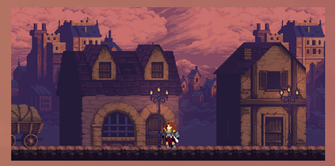
Version3
Game Management

Version4
Level Construct

Version5
Art Assets




Iteration



ME

How does the combat feel after playing?

The three-hit combo looks good, but sometimes the sword connects without dealing damage.

Could the hitbox timing be out of sync with the attack animation?

Possibly. Enemies also barely react when hit, so the attacks lack impact.

I'll adjust the hitbox timing and test hit-stop, knockback, and damage flashes.



Player Tester

Summary

Developing this 2D dungeon-crawler RPG strengthened my skills in character movement, combat combos, and enemy state machines. Debugging animation, collision, and damage systems taught me the importance of modular design and testing. Future improvements will focus on combat feedback, health systems, and gameplay flow. Despite the challenges, turning my ideas into a playable game was highly rewarding.